

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Scenario 02

"Why can I see the Microsoft 365 Copilot adoption report in the Copilot Dashboard but my colleague can't?"

TYPICALLY REPORTED BY

A user who opened a Copilot report and a colleague (same team, similar licence) sees nothing or a permission-denied page.

SURFACES INVOLVED

`analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft`, M365 Admin Center (VFAM), Entra ID

ROLES TOUCHED

Global Admin, Insights Admin, AI Admin, AutoCxO leaders, Delegated users, People-managers

VERSION

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Quick answer

Access to the Copilot Dashboard (and therefore the **Reports** surface inside it) is granted through **five independent paths**. A colleague who sees nothing simply matches *none* of them — even on an identical licence. The Reports surface never has its own permission model: it only shows reports to people who *already* have dashboard access through one of these paths.

#	Access path	Granted to
1	Admin role	Global Administrator, Insights Administrator, or AI Admin
2	AutoCxO (automatic senior-leader identification)	Senior leaders auto-detected from the org hierarchy
3	Delegation	Anyone a leader or admin explicitly shares access with
4	VFAM web-app grant	Users/groups explicitly allowed the Viva Insights web app
5	Manager Settings ("Grant managers scoped access")	Any people-manager whose team meets the minimum team size

The most common single cause

When two colleagues on the same licence differ, the explanation is usually **path 5 (Manager Settings)**: the person who *can* see the report is a people-manager whose team meets the minimum team size; the colleague who *can't* is an individual contributor (no direct reports), or their team is below the minimum, or their **Manager** attribute isn't populated.

30-second diagnosis

1. **Is the colleague a people-manager?** If they have *no direct reports*, paths 2 and 5 can't apply to them. The difference is almost certainly that you have one of those and they don't.
2. **Does the user who *can* see the report hold an admin role?** Check `myaccount.microsoft.com` → *My roles* for Global / Insights / AI Administrator. If yes, that alone explains tenant-wide access — the colleague without the role sees nothing.
3. **Is Manager Settings enabled?** `analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft` → **Admin** → **Manager settings** → confirm “*Grant managers scoped access*” is ON. If off, *no* manager sees team data regardless of licence.
4. **Is the colleague's team below the minimum team size?** Default minimum is 10 (configurable, floor 5) and includes the manager in the count. A manager of a 3-person team sees nothing.
5. **Is the colleague's `Manager` attribute populated?** No manager hierarchy in Entra ID (or uploaded org data) = no manager-scoped access.

Causes ranked by likelihood

#	Cause	Why it happens
1	You have manager-scoped access (path 5) and the colleague is an individual contributor.	Once the Insights / Copilot dashboard is enabled, all users with manager-scoped access can see the dashboard. If the colleague is an individual contributor, they won't see the dashboard.
2	You hold an admin role (path 1); the colleague does not.	Global Admins can see the dashboard. If the colleague is not a Global Admin, they won't see the dashboard.
3	Manager Settings is OFF tenant-wide.	If the Insights / Copilot dashboard is enabled, but Manager Settings is OFF, only Global Admins can see the dashboard.
4	The colleague's team is below the minimum team size.	To protect individual data, the dashboard is only available to users who are part of a team with a minimum size.
5	The colleague's Manager attribute (or manager hierarchy) isn't populated.	Manager-scoped access requires the user's Manager attribute to be populated.
6	You received a delegation (path 3); the colleague did not.	A leader or administrator can delegate access to the dashboard to other users.
7	A VFAM policy blocks the colleague's web-app or Copilot Dashboard access (path 4).	Viva Feature Access Manager (VFAM) policies can restrict access to the dashboard.
8	The colleague lacks a Viva Insights / Copilot licence.	Even with the right permissions, users need a valid licence to access the dashboard.
9	Recent change hasn't propagated yet.	Role assignments and permissions can take time to propagate across the system.

Most common misdiagnosis

This is usually escalated as “the same licence behaves differently for two people — it must be a bug.” In practice the two users almost always differ on **(1) manager status** or **(2) admin role**. Identical licences do *not* imply identical dashboard access — the licence is necessary but not sufficient.

Surface vs. scope — keep these separate

Two different questions are easy to conflate:

- **Does the dashboard / Reports surface appear at all?** → governed by admin role, AutoCxO, delegation, and the VFAM web-app grant (paths 1–4).
- **Does a *manager* see *team-level* data within it?** → governed by Manager Settings + manager hierarchy + minimum team size (path 5).

Diagnose which question you’re actually answering before chasing a fix.

What “done” looks like

- You can articulate *which* of the five paths grants **your** access (admin role, AutoCxO, delegation, VFAM grant, or Manager Settings).
- You’ve confirmed the colleague matches *none* of those paths — or identified the single one that’s missing and fixable (most often: enable Manager Settings, populate the `Manager` attribute, or add a delegation).
- After the relevant change propagates, the colleague either sees the expected scoped report or it’s confirmed as correct-by-design (e.g. an IC with no team to report on).

Related

- [Troubleshooting Scenarios catalogue](#) — browse all scenarios.
 - [Troubleshooting Guide](#) — symptom-tables for single-surface lookups.
 - [Dashboard Guide](#) — access scopes, delegation, and the Reports surface.
 - [Admin Setup Guide](#) — role assignment and Manager Settings step.
 - [Privacy Configuration Guide](#) — minimum team size vs. minimum group size.
 - [FAQ](#) — common access questions.
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